

To create an **Excel Sales Dashboard** using the **Superstore Sales Dataset**, follow this complete workflow.

Objective

Visualize:

- Total Sales
- Total Profit
- Profit by Category
- Sales Trend Over Time
- Top/Bottom Performing Regions or Products
- Highlight High/Low Performers using Conditional Formatting

Step 1: Data Cleaning

Clean the Dataset

Check and fix:

Task	Action
Remove Duplicates	Data → Remove Duplicates
Blank Cells	Fill or remove blanks
Date Format	Convert Order Date to Date format
Currency Format	Format Sales and Profit as Currency
Check Errors	Remove #N/A, #VALUE! etc.

Useful Excel Functions:

`</> excel`



```
TRIM()  
CLEAN()  
IFERROR()  
TEXT()
```

Step 2: Create KPIs

Insert Pivot Table.

KPI Cards

KPI	Formula
Total Sales	=SUM(Sales)
Total Profit	=SUM(Profit)
Total Orders	=COUNT(Order ID)
Average Sales	=AVERAGE(Sales)

Example:

KPI	Value
Total Sales	₹2,297,201
Total Profit	₹286,397
Orders	9,994

Step 3: Profit by Category

Pivot Table

Rows:

- Category

Values:

- Sum of Profit

Insert:

PivotChart → Clustered Column Chart

Example:

Category	Profit
Technology	145K
Office Supplies	122K
Furniture	18K

Step 4: Sales Trend Over Time

Pivot Table

Rows:

- Order Date (Month)

Values:

- Sum of Sales

Insert:

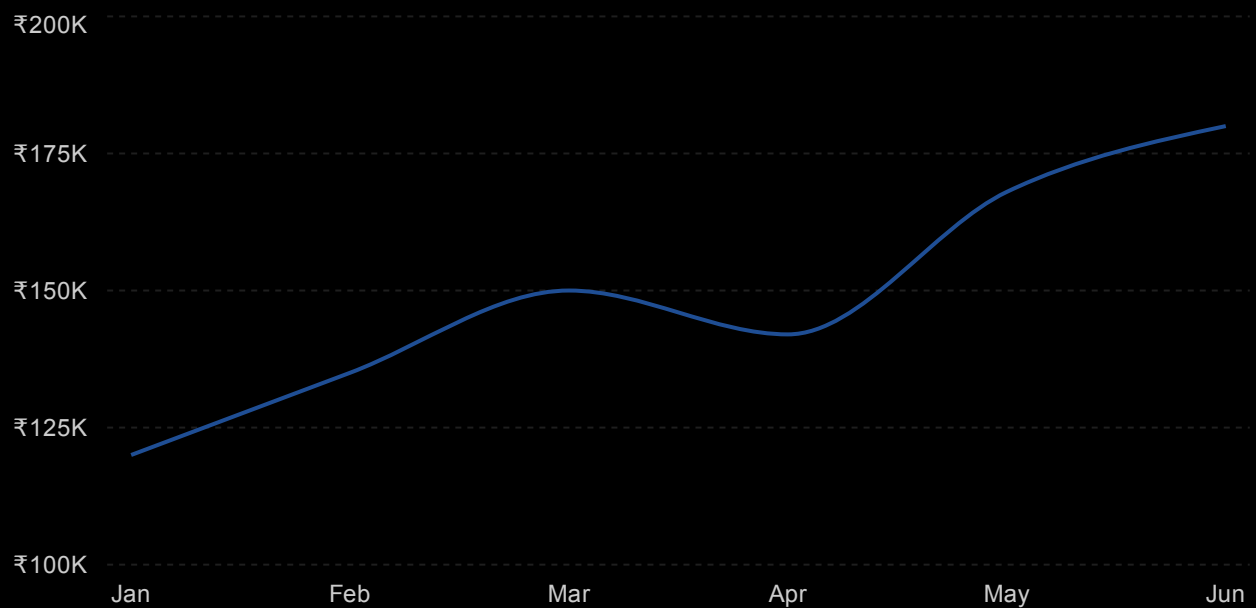
Line Chart

This shows monthly sales growth.

Example Trend:

Monthly sales trend

Example monthly sales trend for dashboard layout.



Step 5: Sales by Region

Pivot Table:

Rows:

- Region

Values:

- Sum of Sales

Insert:

Bar Chart

Example:

Region	Sales
West	725K
East	678K
Central	501K
South	392K

Step 6: Conditional Formatting

Highlight Top Performers

Home → Conditional Formatting → Color Scales

Green:

- High Sales
- High Profit

Red:

- Low Sales
- Negative Profit

Example:

Product	Profit
Laptop	₹25,000 
Printer	₹12,000 
Table	-₹2,500 

Step 7: Add Slicers

Insert → Slicer

Add:

- Category
- Region
- Segment
- Ship Mode

Users can interactively filter dashboard data.

Final Dashboard Layout

| Total Sales | Total Profit | Total Orders |

| Profit by Category | Sales by Region |

| Chart Chart |

| Monthly Sales Trend (Line Chart) |

| Category Slicer | Region Slicer | Segment |



Interview Explanation

"I cleaned the Superstore dataset by removing duplicates, handling missing values, and formatting dates and currency fields. Using Pivot Tables, I created KPIs such as Total Sales and Profit. I built visualizations including Profit by Category, Sales by Region, and Monthly Sales Trends. I added slicers for dynamic filtering and applied conditional formatting to identify high- and low-performing products. The dashboard helps stakeholders quickly monitor sales performance and profitability."

Skills Demonstrated

- Microsoft Excel
- Pivot Tables
- Pivot Charts

- Slicers
- Conditional Formatting
- Data Cleaning
- Dashboard Design
- Business Analytics

This is a strong portfolio project for a Data Analyst internship or entry-level interview.